



Amazon's new robot

Amazon is launching Astro, its first household robot, powered by Alexa. <https://dgit.in/oct21-31>



Pixel 6 is coming soon

Latest Google ad simply says the Pixel 6 is 'coming soon'. <https://dgit.in/oct21-32>

Oppo Enco BudsDecent entry-level choice

Entry-level truly wireless earphones are improving at a meteoric rate. Today, we are reviewing one such entry-level TWS in the sub 2K price segment – the Oppo Enco Buds. The Enco Buds are the successors of the well-liked Oppo Enco W11 and come with some improvements over its predecessor. These earbuds compete with the likes of the Realme Buds Q2 Neo and the Noise Air Buds. Let's see how they fare.

BUILD AND COMFORT

Sporting a pill-shaped charging case, the Oppo Enco Buds have a basic look. The buds come in only White colour, so there's no colour variety like you have with some buds in this price range. The oblong charging case has a small footprint. The front houses an LED battery indicator and the back has the Type-C charging port. It is very hard to open the case one-handed and the case's hinge doesn't feel very robust.

The earbuds have a rounded shape and look pretty Plain Jane as well. There are no eye-catching flourishes, they're just simple stemless TWS earbuds. The back portion of the earbuds are touch-sensitive zones to control music playback and calls. The touch controls are responsive, accurate, and work well, for the most part.

As for the fit, these lightweight earbuds weigh merely 4gs each and are extremely comfortable to wear. The fit is secure as well and doesn't budge too much when you're walking, jogging, or doing chores around your home.

FEATURES

The Oppo Enco Buds are priced under ₹2,000 and come with a fair number of features at this inexpensive price point. First off, the earbuds can leverage the HeyMelody app to check battery levels, perform firmware updates, turn on game mode, and customise earbud controls. These controls can be



used to pause/play music, seek tracks, control volume, turn on game mode, answer calls, and summon voice assistants.

Other features include IP54 dust and water resistance, which means that the buds can withstand light splashes and sweat making them a good option for fitness enthusiasts; there's also 80ms low latency Game Mode.

PERFORMANCE

The Oppo Enco Buds house an 8mm dynamic driver, so it doesn't change much in that aspect compared to the Oppo Enco W11 that also came equipped with an 8mm driver. The buds support SBC and AAC audio codecs and come with Bluetooth v5.2 wireless connectivity, which is an improvement over the Enco W11's Bluetooth 5.0. Now, coming to sound quality, the Oppo Enco Buds come with a warm, bass-boosted sound that many will enjoy. The Oppo Enco Buds has boosted lows. The peak in the bass response is quite substantial, the bass is loud and punchy. While this sounds good with some genres such as pop, hip hop and EDM, the earbuds don't perform well in genres such as rock and classical since the lows eclipse the mids and highs due to auditory masking. The overexaggerated bass shrouds the

clarity of the softer mids and highs. As a result, the buds can produce slightly boomy and dark sound, which we aren't huge fans of. Nevertheless, we are really nitpicking here, the truth is, the sound is pretty decent for a TWS under 2K. The Realme Buds Q2 Neo sound slightly better than these earphones though, so keep that in mind.

As for the microphone, the quality is pretty decent for the price. The voice sounds slightly muffled and we found that external sounds were picked up quite often as well, but it is acceptable at this price range.

BATTERY LIFE

The Oppo Enco Buds' wireless playback time is rated at 24 hours in total, earbuds and charging case combined. The buds themselves have a playback time of 6 hours on a single charge, according to Oppo. In our tests, the earbuds lasted a cool 5 hours and 5 minutes at 60 per cent volume. The charging case provides 3 extra charges, which is decent. The battery life is

better than the Realme Buds Q2 Neo and the Noise Air Buds' 20-hour playtime. So, Oppo has knocked it out of the park here.

VERDICT

Priced under ₹2,000, the Oppo Enco Buds are good options for those looking to purchase a TWS without breaking the bank. At this entry-level price point, you get a fair number of appealing features. The sound quality is a little too bass-biased for our tastes but it's acceptable for the price.

—Dhriti Datta

SPECIFICATIONS

DRIVER: 8 mm dynamic driver | BLUETOOTH CODEC: AAC/SBC | BLUETOOTH VERSION: 5.2 | BLUETOOTH RANGE: 10 m | MUSIC PLAY TIME (50% VOLUME): 6 h (single charge)/ 24 h (with Charging Case) | CHARGING TIME: 120 min (Earbuds)/ 150 min (Earbuds + Charging Case) | CHARGING PORT: USB Type-C | DUST & WATER RESISTANCE (EARBUDS): IP54

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